

Alvaro Mena

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Professional Summary

Lead Fullstack Developer focused on frontend architecture, design systems, and CMS ecosystems, with 20+ years building scalable web platforms. Deep experience with Drupal and WordPress, React and TypeScript, and PHP (Symfony and Laravel), delivering component-driven, API-integrated solutions across healthcare, media, higher education, nonprofit, and agency environments. Provide technical leadership, product and platform thinking, and AI-assisted development, collaborating cross-functionally to ship maintainable, modern web applications.

Frontend Expertise

Frontend architecture, Design systems, Component-driven development, Decoupled Drupal with React, Drupal 10, Single Directory Components (SDC), React, TypeScript, Next.js, REST APIs and API integrations, CMS architecture (Drupal, WordPress), Storybook and Pattern Lab

Hard Skills

REST APIs, API Integrations, CMS Architecture, Design Systems, Component-Driven Development, Frontend Architecture, Performance Optimization, Accessibility (WCAG), Object-Oriented Programming (OOP), MVC Architecture, System Architecture, Technical Documentation, CI/CD, AI-Assisted Development, Prompt Engineering, Automation Workflows

Soft Skills

Technical leadership, Communication, Cross-functional collaboration, Mentorship, Strategic thinking, Problem solving, System architecture thinking, Remote collaboration, Process improvement, Agile Development, Scrum, Technical Screening, Technical Interview, Code Review

Technical Skills

Frontend: Frontend architecture, Design systems, Component-driven development, Decoupled Drupal with React, Drupal 10, Single Directory Components (SDC), React, TypeScript, Next.js, REST APIs and API integrations, CMS architecture (Drupal, WordPress), Storybook and Pattern Lab, TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Next.js, Tailwind CSS

Backend: REST APIs, API Integrations, PHP, C#, SQL, .NET, MySQL

CMS / Platforms: Drupal, Shopify, WordPress

Tooling: Webpack, Acquia, AWS, Compass, DDev, Docker, Git, Gulp, Lando, Pantheon, Pattern Lab, Storybook, Twig, Vite

Work Experience

Lead Developer - Unlock Health

2021-06 - Present

Worked as a senior engineer on large healthcare platforms and digital products used by healthcare organizations across the United States. Most of my work focused on frontend architecture, CMS development, reusable component systems, and helping teams build platforms that could continue evolving over time without becoming difficult to maintain. This included working with Drupal-based implementations using Single Directory Components (SDC) and more modern site-building approaches with Drupal Canvas for visual content composition and reusable layout workflows. I worked closely with designers, backend developers, strategists, and production teams to turn complex requirements into practical, maintainable solutions. A large part of the role involved balancing long-term technical decisions with day-to-day

implementation work across multiple ongoing projects. Over time I also became involved in technical planning, improving frontend workflows, helping define implementation standards, and supporting the broader evolution of the platforms and internal systems we were building.

Prompt Engineering, AI-Assisted Development, REST APIs, Design Systems, CMS Architecture, API Integrations, Atomic Design, Technical Documentation, Technical leadership, Communication, Scrum, Mentorship, Remote collaboration, Strategic thinking, Code Review, Problem solving, JavaScript, TypeScript, HTML5, CSS3, PHP, Tailwind CSS, Alpine.js, React, Symfony, Next.js, Drupal, WordPress, Storybook, Webpack, Git, MySQL, Pattern Lab, Docker, Vite, Gulp, Compass, Lando, Twig, Acquia

Senior Drupal Developer - O3 World

2024-07 - 2025-02

Worked on the development of the Ironman digital platform, helping build and maintain a large-scale web experience designed to support high traffic and ongoing content management needs. The platform was built using Drupal 10 as the CMS, with a decoupled frontend architecture using React and Tailwind. Part of the work involved integrating external APIs, including weather forecast services, and helping ensure the platform remained performant and reliable under heavy usage. I collaborated across frontend, backend, and sitebuilding workflows, working with Acquia Site Studio for content management and page building while also contributing to frontend implementation and overall platform structure. The role involved balancing performance, maintainability, and flexibility across a system that needed to support both complex technical requirements and ongoing editorial use.

REST APIs, Accessibility (WCAG), Component-Driven Development, CMS Architecture, API Integrations, Atomic Design, Communication, Cross-functional collaboration, Strategic thinking, Problem solving, Remote collaboration, Agile Development, JavaScript, PHP, TypeScript, HTML5, CSS3, Symfony, React, Tailwind CSS, Drupal, Twig, Storybook, Vite, Docker, Lando, Git, MySQL, Pantheon

Senior Drupal Developer - Phase2

2021-04 - 2022-07

Collaborated on the development of two large-scale digital platforms: an internal portal for Mastercard and a public-facing platform for the Smithsonian National Air and Space Museum. Most of my work focused on frontend architecture and component-driven development within a Drupal-based CMS environment. The frontend implementation relied heavily on React, TypeScript, Storybook, and Shadow DOM to build reusable and isolated interface components that could scale across large platforms and multiple teams. I worked closely with designers, frontend developers, and backend teams to translate complex design systems into maintainable frontend implementations while helping ensure consistency across the different areas of each platform. A large part of the work involved building reusable UI systems, improving frontend workflows, and supporting long-term maintainability in projects with complex requirements and high visibility.

Accessibility (WCAG), API Integrations, REST APIs, Performance Optimization, Component-Driven Development, Communication, Strategic thinking, Problem solving, Remote collaboration, Scrum, PHP, JavaScript, TypeScript, CSS3, HTML5, Symfony, React, Drupal, Twig, Storybook, Vite, Docker, DDev, Git, MySQL, Acquia

Lead Developer - We Are Conduct

2019-04 - 2021-06

Worked across a mix of Drupal, Laravel, Vue.js, and .NET projects, contributing to both long-term platform maintenance and the development of new applications and features. A significant part of my role involved leading and implementing Drupal 7 to Drupal 8 migrations, helping modernize legacy platforms while improving performance, scalability, and long-term maintainability. I also worked on architecting Drupal solutions from project requirements, building custom modules, and supporting ongoing platform evolution. Beyond Drupal, I collaborated on applications built with Laravel and Vue.js, while also helping maintain and extend projects developed on .NET-based systems. Much of the work required coordinating across frontend, backend, and infrastructure concerns to ensure different systems could integrate and evolve cleanly together. The role involved balancing technical planning, hands-on implementation, and long-term support across projects with very different architectures and business needs.

CMS Architecture, MVC Architecture, Object-Oriented Programming (OOP), Performance Optimization, REST APIs, API Integrations, System Architecture, Technical Documentation, Technical leadership, Communication, Cross-functional

collaboration, Mentorship, Problem solving, System architecture thinking, Process improvement, Agile Development, PHP, JavaScript, TypeScript, C#, HTML5, CSS3, Python, Symfony, .NET, Laravel, Flask, Drupal, WordPress, Shopify, Pattern Lab, Gulp, Webpack, Docker, DDev, Git, MySQL, Acquia, Pantheon, Twig

Drupal CMS Screener Developer - Toptal

2017-04 - 2020-07

Worked as a technical screener focused on evaluating Drupal developers applying to the platform. The role involved reviewing technical knowledge, problem-solving approaches, architecture decisions, code quality, and real-world Drupal experience across developers with different levels of seniority and backgrounds. I conducted technical interviews, assessed implementation approaches, and helped determine whether candidates met the standards expected for client-facing engineering work. A large part of the process was understanding not only whether someone could write code, but also how they approached maintainability, scalability, communication, and long-term project thinking. The position gave me exposure to a wide range of development styles, architectures, and engineering practices across the broader Drupal ecosystem.

Technical leadership, Communication, Code Review, Technical Interview, Technical Screening, Agile Development, PHP, CSS3, HTML5, JavaScript, Drupal, Twig, Git

Senior Fullstack Developer - Taoti Creative

2018-06 - 2019-03

Worked on Drupal and WordPress projects with a strong focus on frontend architecture, platform structure, and long-term maintainability. Most of my work involved leading frontend implementation for Drupal 8 platforms, translating design systems into reusable themes and component-based interfaces that could scale cleanly as projects evolved. I also maintained and extended WordPress sites, contributing both frontend and structural improvements depending on the needs of each project. Beyond implementation work, I collaborated on broader site architecture decisions to help ensure platforms remained flexible, maintainable, and aligned with long-term project goals. The role combined hands-on frontend development with architectural thinking across multiple CMS-driven platforms and client projects.

Communication, Strategic thinking, Problem solving, Remote collaboration, Scrum, PHP, JavaScript, TypeScript, HTML5, CSS3, Symfony, Drupal, WordPress, Pattern Lab, Gulp, Webpack, Git, MySQL, Pantheon, Twig

Senior Drupal Developer - Continion

2017-03 - 2018-06

Worked part-time as the lead developer supporting and evolving the digital platform for St. Edward's University. The role involved maintaining and extending an existing Drupal platform while also leading the migration from Drupal 7 to Drupal 8. Much of the work focused on improving long-term maintainability, implementing new features, handling content migrations, and ensuring the transition between platforms remained stable and manageable. I also worked on integrations between systems and collaborated with different teams to support both ongoing operational needs and larger platform improvements. The position required balancing technical planning, hands-on development, and long-term platform support within an active production environment used by the university community.

REST APIs, Responsive Web Design, Performance Optimization, MVC Architecture, Object-Oriented Programming (OOP), Design Systems, Component-Driven Development, CMS Architecture, API Integrations, Atomic Design, Technical leadership, Communication, Cross-functional collaboration, Strategic thinking, Problem solving, System architecture thinking, Remote collaboration, Scrum, JavaScript, HTML5, CSS3, Python, PHP, Laravel, Symfony, Flask, Drupal, Twig, Pattern Lab, Gulp, Compass, Webpack, Docker, Git, MySQL, Acquia

Senior Drupal Developer - Longboard

2017-03 - 2018

Worked part-time maintaining and extending the company's Drupal 8 platform, contributing both to ongoing development work and the design of new platform features. The role involved implementing new functionality, maintaining existing systems, and helping improve the overall user experience of the platform as it evolved over time. In addition to development work, I also collaborated on UX thinking and interface design for new features, helping shape how they would

function and be presented to users. Much of the work required balancing technical implementation with usability and long-term maintainability, while supporting the day-to-day needs of an active production platform.

Atomic Design, CMS Architecture, Design Systems, Responsive Web Design, REST APIs, Performance Optimization, Accessibility (WCAG), API Integrations, Communication, Strategic thinking, Problem solving, System architecture thinking, Remote collaboration, Process improvement, PHP, JavaScript, Python, C#, HTML5, CSS3, Laravel, Symfony, Flask, .NET, Drupal, Twig, Pattern Lab, Gulp, Compass, Webpack, Docker, Git, MySQL, Pantheon, AWS

Senior Developer - Jobsity

2013-03 - 2017-03

Worked in a mentorship-focused role supporting developers preparing for technical interviews and client-facing engineering positions, primarily around Drupal, WordPress, and PHP development. I helped mentor developers across different levels of experience, providing guidance on architecture decisions, debugging approaches, code quality, and the kinds of engineering practices expected in real production environments. A large part of the role involved helping developers improve both their technical skills and their ability to communicate their thinking during interviews and client interactions. I was also frequently the first developer assigned to new client engagements that required Drupal, WordPress, or PHP fullstack expertise. This involved helping establish technical direction, evaluating project requirements, building initial implementations, and setting development foundations that other engineers could continue working from over time. The role combined technical leadership, mentorship, and hands-on engineering work across a variety of teams, projects, and client environments.

Technical leadership, Communication, Cross-functional collaboration, Mentorship, Strategic thinking, Problem solving, Scrum

Senior Drupal Front-end Specialist - New Target

2014-08 - 2017-03

Worked remotely on digital platforms and applications for NGOs and government-related organizations, while also providing onsite support when required due to security clearance and operational requirements tied to specific projects. The role involved collaborating across distributed teams to build and maintain CMS-driven platforms and custom application functionality, with a strong focus on reliability, maintainability, and structured development processes. The onsite portions of the work allowed for closer collaboration with stakeholders, project teams, and operational staff in environments where direct coordination and security protocols were an important part of the development process. The position combined remote engineering work with onsite technical support across projects operating under more security-sensitive requirements and workflows.

REST APIs, Responsive Web Design, Object-Oriented Programming (OOP), CMS Architecture, API Integrations, Atomic Design, Technical Documentation, Communication, Cross-functional collaboration, Strategic thinking, Problem solving, System architecture thinking, Remote collaboration, Agile Development, PHP, JavaScript, HTML5, CSS3, Symfony, Drupal, Pattern Lab, Compass, Gulp, Git, Docker, Acquia, Pantheon

Drupal Developer - ProPeople

2014-03 - 2014-08

Collaborated on the migration of NFL team websites from Sitecore to Drupal, helping transition large-scale sports platforms into a more flexible and maintainable CMS ecosystem. The work involved supporting the migration process across frontend and CMS-related implementation tasks, while helping ensure continuity between the legacy platform structure and the new Drupal-based architecture. Much of the project focused on maintaining consistency across multiple team sites while adapting platform functionality, content structures, and frontend behavior to the new system. The role required balancing migration work, platform standardization, and ongoing implementation needs within a large multi-site environment with high visibility and active audiences.

REST APIs, Performance Optimization, Accessibility (WCAG), Object-Oriented Programming (OOP), CMS Architecture, API Integrations, Atomic Design, Technical Documentation, Communication, Cross-functional collaboration, Strategic thinking, Problem solving, Remote collaboration, Agile Development

Senior Drupal Developer - Code & Theory

2013-03 - 2014-03

Worked as a Senior Fullstack Drupal Developer across multiple large-scale projects for the NBC Sports Group, including platforms related to Golf Channel and the Winter Olympics, while collaborating with both East Coast and West Coast engineering teams. The work involved building and maintaining high-traffic digital platforms with a strong focus on Drupal development, frontend implementation, and large-scale content-driven experiences tied to major live sports events and media coverage. I collaborated closely with distributed teams across different time zones, contributing to both backend and frontend development, platform architecture, and ongoing feature implementation within fast-moving production environments. A large part of the role involved balancing performance, maintainability, and rapid iteration across projects operating at significant scale and visibility.

CMS Architecture, MVC Architecture, Object-Oriented Programming (OOP), Performance Optimization, Component-Driven Development, Atomic Design, API Integrations, Technical Documentation, Communication, Cross-functional collaboration, Strategic thinking, Problem solving, Remote collaboration, Scrum, PHP, JavaScript, SQL, HTML5, CSS3, Drupal, Compass, Acquia, MySQL, Git

Early Career

2004-08 to 2013-03

Earlier experience includes 4 roles covering Responsive Web Design, REST APIs, Performance Optimization, Object-Oriented Programming (OOP), MVC Architecture, Design Systems, CMS Architecture, Atomic Design, Technical leadership, Communication.

Education

Licentiate Degree in Multimedia Design - Instituto Metropolitano de Diseño

Quito, Ecuador | 2004 - 2007

Master's in Web Development and Web Design - Escuela de artes digitales

Buenos Aires, Argentina | 2008 - 2010

Certifications

Acquia Certified Developer

Languages

English - C2